

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES

Nexora Technologies Employee Handbook

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Nexora Technologies Private Limited · CIN U72200HR2011PTC043117
Registered office: Nexora Tower, Plot 17, Sector 44, Gurugram, Haryana 122003
Offices at Gurugram (HQ), Bengaluru and Pune

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Section numbering in this document is stable across versions. Where a clause has been withdrawn the number is retained and marked withdrawn, so that cross-references from other policies continue to resolve.

1. About This Handbook

1.1 Purpose

This Handbook is the consolidated statement of the terms, conditions, expectations and entitlements that govern employment at Nexora Technologies Private Limited ("Nexora", "the Company"). It is issued under the authority of the Chief Human Resources Officer and is binding on all persons who appear on the Nexora payroll.

The Handbook has three purposes. First, it tells you what the Company has committed to provide you. Second, it tells you what the Company expects from you in return. Third, it tells you where to go when something is unclear, unfair or has gone wrong. Where any of these three things is not addressed here, the correct answer is not to improvise; it is to raise a query with the HR Helpdesk at hrhelpdesk@nexoratech.in.

1.2 Scope and Applicability

This Handbook applies to:

- (a) all confirmed employees of Nexora Technologies Private Limited across the Gurugram, Bengaluru and Pune offices;
- (b) all employees serving probation, except where a clause is expressly stated to apply only on confirmation;
- (c) all Graduate Engineer Trainees (GETs) enrolled in the Nexora Launchpad programme, except in respect of Clause 6.5 (Variable Pay), which does not apply during the training period; and
- (d) all fixed-term contract employees on Nexora rolls, except in respect of Clause 7.4 (Meal Card), Clause 7.6 (Relocation Assistance) and Clause 8.4 (Promotions).

This Handbook does **not** apply to independent contractors, consultants engaged on a statement of work, vendor personnel, staffing-partner deputies or interns engaged for fewer than 90 days. Those relationships are governed exclusively by their respective contracts and by the Nexora Third Party Code of Conduct (LEG-POL-003).

1.3 How to Use This Handbook

The Handbook is a summary instrument. For eleven subject areas it defers to a detailed policy, and where the Handbook and the detailed policy differ, the detailed policy prevails. The detailed policies are:

Subject	Governing policy	Document ID
Leave and attendance	Leave and Attendance Policy	HR-POL-004
Conduct, ethics and POSH	Code of Conduct and POSH Policy	HR-POL-002
Compensation and payroll	Compensation, Benefits and Payroll Policy	HR-POL-007
Onboarding and training	Onboarding and Training Manual	HR-MAN-011
Travel and expenses	Travel and Expense Reimbursement Policy	FIN-POL-006
Remote and hybrid working	Remote and Hybrid Work Guidelines	HR-POL-012
Performance management	Performance Review Process	HR-POL-009
Information security	Information Security Policy	ISMS-POL-001

Subject	Governing policy	Document ID
Acceptable use of IT	Acceptable Use Policy	ISMS-POL-004
Whistleblowing	Vigil Mechanism and Whistleblower Policy	LEG-POL-002
Data protection	Personal Data Protection Policy	LEG-POL-005

1.4 Amendment, Review and Precedence

The Company reserves the right to amend, withdraw or supplement any clause of this Handbook at its sole discretion, subject to applicable law. Material amendments are notified on the PeopleHub announcements module and by email to all employees at least fifteen (15) calendar days before they take effect. Amendments that are required by a change in statute take effect on the statutory date irrespective of the notice period.

This Handbook supersedes Employee Handbook v2.4 dated 1 July 2021 and all HR circulars issued before 1 April 2024 to the extent of inconsistency. Nothing in this Handbook creates a contract of employment for a fixed term, nor does it limit the Company's rights under the individual appointment letter, which prevails over this Handbook in the event of a direct conflict.

1.5 Acknowledgement

Every employee must record an electronic acknowledgement of this Handbook on PeopleHub within fourteen (14) calendar days of joining, and again within thirty (30) calendar days of the release of any revised version. Non-acknowledgement does not exempt an employee from the Handbook's application. The acknowledgement register is maintained by the HR Operations team and is audited annually as part of the ISO 27001:2022 surveillance audit.

2. About Nexora Technologies

2.1 Who We Are

Nexora Technologies Private Limited was incorporated in Haryana on 9 September 2011 under CIN U72200HR2011PTC043117. We are a mid-sized IT services and engineering organisation of 1,240 employees (headcount as at 1 April 2026) serving 47 active clients across banking and financial services, insurance, retail and logistics, and healthcare technology.

Our delivery model is built on four practices:

1. **Application Engineering** — custom application development, modernisation of legacy

estates, and product engineering services.

2. **Cloud and Platform Services** — migration, landing-zone design, FinOps and managed

operations on AWS, Azure and Google Cloud.

3. **Data and Analytics** — data platform engineering, warehouse modernisation, business

intelligence and applied machine learning.

4. **Quality Engineering** — test automation, performance engineering and continuous

quality enablement.

2.2 Vision, Mission and Values

Vision. To be the engineering partner our clients call first when the work is hard.

Mission. To build software that is correct, maintainable and honestly delivered, and to build the careers of the people who write it.

Values. Nexora recognises five values. They are not decorative; they are the criteria used in the annual performance review (see Clause 8.2) and in disciplinary assessment (see Clause 15).

- **Craft.** We take responsibility for the quality of what we ship, including the parts nobody is going to inspect.
- **Candour.** We tell clients and each other the truth about status, risk and estimates, early and without decoration.
- **Custody.** We treat client data, client systems and colleague trust as things held in custody, not things owned.
- **Curiosity.** We invest in learning ahead of demand, not after it.
- **Care.** We treat colleagues as people with lives outside the office.

2.3 Locations

Site	Address	Function	Approx. headcount
Gurugram (HQ)	Nexora Tower, Plot 17, Sector 44, Gurugram, Haryana 122003	Corporate functions, BFSI delivery, Presales	520
Bengaluru	Level 6–8, Prestige Tech Park III, Outer Ring Road, Kadubeesanahalli, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560103	Cloud, Data and Analytics, Product Engineering	465
Pune	Tower B, Panchshil Business Park, Viman Nagar, Pune, Maharashtra 411014	Quality Engineering, Managed Services, Shared Services	255

Registered office and the office of the Company Secretary is the Gurugram address above. All statutory notices, including those under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, are displayed on the notice board at Level 3 reception of each site and on the PeopleHub Policies module.

2.4 Career Bands and Designations

Nexora operates an eight-band career structure. Bands govern approval authority, variable pay percentage, notice period, relocation entitlement and travel class. They do not, by themselves, govern compensation, which is set by the salary range for the band and role family (see HR-POL-007, Clause 3).

Band	Typical designations	Indicative experience
B1	Associate Software Engineer, Associate QA Engineer, HR Executive, Finance Executive	0–2 years
B2	Software Engineer, QA Engineer, Data Engineer, IT Support Engineer, Talent Acquisition Specialist	2–4 years
B3	Senior Software Engineer, Senior QA Engineer, Senior Data Engineer, DevOps Engineer, HR Business Partner, Business Analyst	4–7 years
B4	Technical Lead, Lead Engineer, Technical Architect, Senior Business Analyst, Scrum Master	7–11 years
B5	Engineering Manager, Delivery Manager, Senior Technical Architect, Manager – Human Resources	10–14 years
B6	Senior Manager, Program Manager, Practice Lead, Senior Manager – Finance	13–18 years
B7	Director, Practice Head, Senior Director	17–22 years
B8	Vice President, Senior Vice President	20+ years

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The Executive Leadership Team (ELT) sits outside the band structure and comprises the Chief Executive Officer, Chief Operating Officer, Chief Financial Officer, Chief Technology Officer, Chief Human Resources Officer and General Counsel.

2.5 Who to Contact

Need	Channel	Service level
Any HR query, policy clarification, letters	hrhelpdesk@nexoratech.in / PeopleHub → Helpdesk	First response 1 business day; resolution 3 business days
Payroll, payslip, tax declaration, Form 16	payroll@nexoratech.in	2 business days

Need	Channel	Service level
IT access, hardware, VPN, software	NexServe portal → Raise Ticket	P1 4 hours; P2 1 business day; P3 3 business days
Insurance claim, TPA escalation	benefits@nexoratech.in	2 business days
Ethics concern, whistleblowing	ethics@nexoratech.in / IntegriLine 1800-419-6272	Acknowledgement 3 business days
POSH complaint	posh.ic@nexoratech.in or the Presiding Officer for your site	Acknowledgement 2 business days
Facilities, seating, access card	facilities@nexoratech.in	1 business day

3. The Employment Relationship

3.1 Categories of Employment

3.1.1 Permanent employees are engaged without a fixed end date, subject to the notice provisions in Clause 16.1. They are eligible for the full benefits set out in Clause 7.

3.1.2 Probationers are permanent employees who have not yet been confirmed. All new hires, whether fresher or lateral, serve a probation period of six (6) months from the date of joining. Probation may be extended once, by a maximum of three (3) months, by the reporting manager with the written concurrence of the HR Business Partner and the Band B6-or-above function head.

3.1.3 Fixed-term contract employees are engaged for a defined period, ordinarily between six and twenty-four months, against a funded client engagement. Fixed-term contracts do not renew automatically. Statutory benefits (Provident Fund, ESI where applicable, gratuity where the statutory service condition is met) apply in full.

3.1.4 Graduate Engineer Trainees (GETs) are campus hires enrolled in Nexora Launchpad. GETs serve a training period of eight (8) weeks followed by a probation of six (6) months from the date of deployment to a project. GET appointments carry a service commitment of eighteen (18) months from the date of joining, as recorded in the GET appointment letter.

3.1.5 Interns are engaged for a period of eight to twenty-four weeks against a defined project. Interns receive a stipend, are not on the benefits programme, and are covered by the Company's Group Personal Accident policy only.

3.2 Recruitment and Selection

Recruitment is conducted by the Talent Acquisition team under the Head of Talent Acquisition. Every open role must have an approved Position Requisition on PeopleHub carrying (i) the budget code, (ii) the band, (iii) the location, and (iv) the approval of the function head and, for any position at Band B5 and above, of the Chief Financial Officer.

Nexora is an equal opportunity employer. Selection is on merit alone. The Company does not discriminate on the basis of religion, race, caste, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, place of birth, descent, marital status, pregnancy, disability, age or any other status protected by law. Interview panels for Band B4 and above must include at least one member from a different function than the hiring manager.

Employee referrals. Nexora encourages referrals. Referral awards are set out in Clause 7.7. Employees must not participate in any stage of the selection process for a candidate they have referred, nor for any relative as defined in Section 2(77) of the Companies Act, 2013.

3.3 Offer, Documentation and Background Verification

An offer of employment is made in writing by the Talent Acquisition team and is valid for seven (7) calendar days from the date of issue unless extended in writing. Verbal offers are not binding on the Company.

Every offer is conditional upon successful completion of background verification (BGV), which is conducted by our screening partner, VeriTrust Screening Services Private Limited. The standard check set comprises:

Check	Scope	Typical turnaround
Employment	Last 7 years or last 3 employers, whichever is shorter	7–12 business days

Check	Scope	Typical turnaround
Education	Highest qualification only	10–21 business days
Address	Current permanent address, physical or digital	5–7 business days
Criminal record	Court records at current and permanent address	7–10 business days
Global database	Sanctions, PEP and adverse media screening	2 business days
Drug screen	Only for engagements with clients contractually requiring it	3 business days

A candidate whose BGV returns a **Red** finding — a material discrepancy such as fabricated employment, a forged qualification, or an undisclosed conviction — will have the offer withdrawn, or, if already joined, will have their services terminated with immediate effect under Clause 15.4. An **Amber** finding is reviewed by a panel comprising the HR Business Partner, the hiring manager and a representative of Legal and Compliance.

Documents to be submitted on or before the date of joining are listed in HR-MAN-011, Clause 2.3. The relieving letter and the final salary slip from the previous employer must be uploaded within thirty (30) days of joining. Failure to do so places the confirmation decision on hold and, after ninety (90) days, is treated as a Red BGV finding.

3.4 Probation and Confirmation

During probation, an employee's performance is reviewed formally at the end of month three and month six by the reporting manager on the PeopleHub Probation Review form. The review records observed performance against the role's 30-60-90 day plan (see HR-MAN-011, Clause 6) and returns one of four outcomes:

Outcome	Consequence
Confirm	Confirmation letter issued with effect from the completion date of probation
Extend	Probation extended by up to 3 months with a documented improvement plan
Redeploy	Employee moved to a different role or project; probation clock restarts at month 3
Discontinue	Services terminated with 30 days' notice or notice pay in lieu

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Confirmation is not automatic. Where no confirmation decision is recorded within thirty

(30) days of the probation completion date, the employee is deemed confirmed with effect

from the probation completion date. During probation, the notice period on either side is thirty (30) calendar days.

3.5 Internal Mobility

Employees who have completed eighteen (18) months in their current role and hold a performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or better in the most recent cycle may apply for internal openings through the PeopleHub Internal Job Board. The releasing manager may withhold release for a maximum of sixty (60) days for engagement continuity; withholding beyond sixty days requires the written approval of the Chief Operating Officer.

Internal transfers do not reset the probation clock, do not affect the date of joining for gratuity or leave accrual purposes, and do not trigger a compensation revision except where the move involves a band change, in which case Clause 8.4 applies.

3.6 Re-hire

Former employees who left in good standing, served their full notice, and completed exit formalities are eligible for re-hire after a cooling period of six (6) months. Re-hire requires the approval of the CHRO. A re-hired employee's earlier service does not count towards gratuity, leave accrual or long-service recognition unless the break in service was less than ninety (90) days and the re-hire was approved as a "continuity re-hire".

Employees who were terminated for cause, who abandoned service under Clause 4.7, or whose BGV returned a Red finding are permanently ineligible for re-hire and are recorded as such on the Do Not Rehire register maintained by HR Operations.

4. Working Hours, Attendance and Workplace Model

4.1 The Standard Work Week

The standard work week at Nexora is Monday to Friday. The standard working day is nine (9) hours, inclusive of a sixty (60) minute unpaid meal break and two paid rest breaks of fifteen (15) minutes each. This gives a net working time of eight (8) hours per day and forty (40) hours per week.

Saturdays and Sundays are weekly offs. Where a client engagement requires a different weekly pattern — for example a Sunday-to-Thursday week for a Gulf-region client — the pattern is documented in the engagement's Delivery Operating Model and approved by the Delivery Manager and HRBP. In no case will an employee be scheduled for more than six consecutive working days without a weekly off.

4.2 Flexible Start and Core Hours

Nexora operates a flexible start window. Employees may begin work at any time between 08:00 and 11:00 IST, provided they complete their net eight hours and are available during **core hours of 11:00 to 17:00 IST**. Core hours are when meetings, stand-ups, design reviews and client calls are scheduled. Employees must not schedule recurring internal meetings outside core hours without the agreement of every required attendee.

Flexibility is a facility, not an entitlement, and may be restricted at project level where a client's contracted service window requires it. Any such restriction must be recorded in the engagement's Delivery Operating Model.

4.3 Attendance Recording

Attendance is recorded in two ways, both of which are mandatory:

1. **Access-card swipe** at the turnstiles on entry to and exit from the office floor. The first swipe of the day and the last swipe of the day define the in-office duration.
2. **PeopleHub check-in**, completed from the Nexora network or through the PeopleHub mobile application with location services enabled.

A day is counted as follows:

Net hours recorded	Attendance credit
8.0 hours or more	Full day
4.5 to 7.99 hours	Half day (0.5 day leave deducted)
Less than 4.5 hours	Absent (1 day leave deducted)

Missed swipes must be regularised on PeopleHub within seven (7) calendar days through the Attendance Regularisation workflow, with manager approval. A maximum of three (3) regularisations per calendar month is permitted. Regularisation requests raised after the seven-day window require HRBP approval and are granted only in exceptional circumstances.

4.4 Late Marks

An arrival recorded after 11:00 IST without a prior approved exception is a **late mark**. Three (3) late marks in a calendar month result in the deduction of one half-day of Casual Leave. Six (6) or more late marks in a calendar month are treated as an attendance deficiency and are addressed under Clause 15.2 (Counselling).

Late marks are not recorded for employees on an approved shift roster, on client-site deputation, on approved travel, or where the delay is attributable to a documented event such as a transport strike or a civic emergency notified by the Facilities team.

4.5 Shifts

Nexora operates three shifts to support client service windows:

Shift	Timing (IST)	Allowance per shift worked
General	09:00–18:00 (flexi window applies)	Nil
Evening (Shift B)	14:00–23:00	INR 300
Night (Shift C)	21:30–06:30	INR 550

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Shift rosters are published by the Delivery Manager at least seven (7) calendar days before the start of the roster month. No employee may be rostered on the night shift for more than fourteen (14) consecutive calendar days, or for more than ninety (90) days in a rolling twelve-month period, without their written consent recorded on PeopleHub.

In accordance with the Haryana Shops and Commercial Establishments rules and equivalent State provisions in Karnataka and Maharashtra, women employees rostered between 20:00 and 06:00 are provided door-to-door Company-arranged transport with a security escort, and may decline a night-shift roster without adverse consequence. The Facilities team maintains the night transport roster and the escort attendance register at each site.

4.6 Hybrid Working

Nexora operates a hybrid working model. All employees, other than those designated "Site-Anchored" or "Fully Remote", are required to work from their assigned office for a minimum of **twelve (12) working days per calendar month**, of which at least one day each month must coincide with the team's designated anchor day.

Designations are:

- **Site-Anchored** — roles requiring physical presence on all working days: IT Support, Facilities, Reception, Security, Lab and Hardware Engineering, and any role on a client engagement with a contractual on-site clause.
- **Hybrid** — the default designation for all other roles.
- **Fully Remote** — an exception approved by the function head and CHRO, reviewed every six months, and available only where the role has no on-site dependency and the employee has completed twelve (12) months of service.

Detailed provisions on eligibility, equipment, the internet reimbursement and cross-city working are set out in the Remote and Hybrid Work Guidelines (HR-POL-012).

4.7 Absence Without Approval

Absence from work without an approved leave application or a communication to the reporting manager is unauthorised absence and is treated as Loss of Pay for the days in question.

- **Three (3) consecutive working days** of unauthorised absence: the reporting manager contacts the employee on the registered mobile number and email, and records the attempt on PeopleHub.
- **Five (5) consecutive working days**: HR issues a written show-cause notice to the employee's registered address by email and registered post, requiring a response within seven (7) days.
- **Eight (8) consecutive working days** with no satisfactory response: the employee is deemed to have voluntarily abandoned service. The employment record is closed with effect from the first day of unauthorised absence, no relieving letter is issued, and the employee is placed on the Do Not Rehire register.

5. Leave — Summary

This clause is a summary only. The Leave and Attendance Policy (HR-POL-004) is the governing document and prevails in the event of any inconsistency.

The Nexora leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**, irrespective of the financial year, which runs from 1 April to 31 March.

5.1 Leave Types and Annual Entitlement

Leave type	Annual entitlement	Credit method	Carry forward
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	3 days credited on the first day of each quarter	Not permitted; lapses on 31 December
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days	Credited in full on 1 January	Not permitted; lapses on 31 December
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days on completion of each calendar month	Up to 30 days
Compensatory Off	As earned	On approved work on a weekly off or holiday	Must be availed within 45 days of the date earned
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	On application	Not applicable
Paternity Leave	5 working days	On application	Not applicable
Bereavement Leave	5 calendar days per event	On application	Not applicable
Marriage Leave	5 working days, once in tenure	On application	Not applicable

Leave in the year of joining is credited on a pro-rata basis from the date of joining. Employees joining on or before the 15th of a month are credited for that full month; employees joining on or after the 16th are credited from the following month.

5.2 Applying for Leave

All leave must be applied for on PeopleHub and approved by the reporting manager before it is taken, except in the case of Sick Leave or a genuine emergency, which must be applied for retrospectively on the first working day after return.

Advance notice requirements:

- Casual Leave: at least one (1) working day in advance.
- Earned Leave of three (3) or more consecutive days: at least seven (7) calendar days in advance.
- Earned Leave of five (5) or more consecutive days: at least fifteen (15) calendar days in advance.
- Any leave of ten (10) or more consecutive days: additionally requires the approval of the Delivery Manager and the HRBP.

Sick Leave of more than two (2) consecutive working days must be supported by a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner, uploaded to PeopleHub within seven (7) days of return.

5.3 Public Holidays

Nexora observes ten (10) fixed holidays common to all locations, one or two location-specific regional holidays, and two (2) optional holidays selected by the employee from a published list. The holiday calendar for the following year is published by 30 November each year.

A fixed holiday that falls on a weekly off is not compensated with an alternative day.

5.4 Encashment

Earned Leave in excess of the thirty (30) day carry-forward cap is encashed automatically in the January payroll at the rate of $(\text{Basic} + \text{Dearness Allowance}) \div 30$ per day. Casual Leave, Sick Leave and Compensatory Off are not encashable at any time. On separation, accumulated Earned Leave up to a maximum of thirty (30) days is encashed in the full and final settlement.

6. Compensation — Summary

This clause is a summary only. The Compensation, Benefits and Payroll Policy (HR-POL-007) is the governing document.

6.1 Salary Structure

Nexora expresses compensation as Cost to Company (CTC), which comprises Fixed Pay, Variable Pay and Retirals. The standard fixed-pay construction is:

Component	Basis
Basic Salary	40% of annual Fixed Pay
House Rent Allowance	50% of Basic Salary
Leave Travel Allowance	INR 40,000 per annum
Meal Card credit	INR 26,400 per annum (INR 2,200 per month)
Special Allowance	Balancing figure

Retirals comprise the employer contribution to the Employees' Provident Fund, the gratuity provision at 4.81% of Basic Salary, and, where opted, the employer contribution to the National Pension System.

6.2 Payroll Cycle

The payroll month runs from the 1st to the last day of the calendar month. The attendance and input cut-off is the **18th** of the month; changes received after the cut-off are processed in the following month's payroll. Salary is credited on the **last working day** of the month. Where the last working day falls on a bank holiday, credit is advanced to the preceding working day.

Payslips are published on PeopleHub → My Pay by the 3rd working day of the following month. Form 16 is issued by 15 June for the preceding financial year.

6.3 Annual Increment and Variable Pay

The annual compensation review is effective 1 July each year and is based on the performance rating for the appraisal cycle ending 31 March. Variable pay is calculated on the annual performance rating and the achievement of Company and business-unit targets, and is disbursed with the June payroll. Variable pay opportunity by band is:

Band	Variable pay as % of CTC
B1–B2	5%
B3	8%
B4	12%
B5–B6	15%
B7–B8	20%

Employees who have resigned, or who are serving notice, on the date of disbursement are not eligible for variable pay. Employees who joined on or after 1 January of the assessment year receive variable pay on a pro-rata basis.

7. Benefits and Welfare

7.1 Group Insurance

Policy	Cover	Who is covered	Employee cost
Group Mediclaim (GMC)	INR 5,00,000 family floater	Self, spouse, up to 2 dependent children	Nil
GMC — parental top-up	INR 5,00,000 floater for parents or parents-in-law	Optional, employee's election	INR 18,500 per parent per year, payroll-deducted
Group Personal Accident (GPA)	3 × annual Fixed Pay, capped at INR 1,50,00,000	Self	Nil
Group Term Life (GTL)	3 × annual CTC	Self	Nil

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The insurer is Sarvodaya General Insurance Company Limited and the third-party administrator is MedAssist Services Private Limited. Enrolment of dependants must be completed within thirty (30) days of joining or within thirty (30) days of a qualifying life event (marriage, childbirth, legal adoption). Outside those windows, additions are possible only at the annual policy renewal on 1 July.

Maternity is covered within the family floater up to INR 75,000 for a normal delivery and INR 1,00,000 for a caesarean delivery, with a waiting period of nine (9) months from the date of policy inception for the employee.

7.2 Statutory Retirals

Provident Fund. Both employee and employer contribute 12% of Basic Salary, subject to the statutory wage ceiling of INR 15,000 per month for the employer's contribution unless the employee has elected contribution on full Basic. Employees may make Voluntary Provident Fund contributions of up to 88% of Basic; elections are accepted in April and October only.

Gratuity. Payable on separation after five (5) years of continuous service, computed as $(15 \div 26) \times$ last drawn (Basic + DA) $\times$ completed years of service, subject to the statutory cap. The five-year condition is waived in the case of death or permanent disablement.

National Pension System. Optional. Employees may direct up to 10% of Basic Salary as an employer NPS contribution within their existing CTC, which is deductible under Section 80CCD(2) of the Income-tax Act, 1961. Elections are accepted twice a year, in April and October.

7.3 Wellness and Employee Assistance

- **Annual health check.** A Company-funded annual health check at a partner diagnostic chain for all employees who have completed six months of service. Employees aged 40 and above receive the extended panel.
- **Employee Assistance Programme (EAP).** Nexora contracts with Ashray Wellbeing Services for confidential counselling. Employees and their immediate family members are entitled to eight (8) counselling sessions per person per year at no cost, accessible on 1800-102-8899 or through the Ashray app. Nexora receives only anonymised utilisation statistics and never receives the identity of a caller or the content of a session.

- **Wellness allowance.** INR 6,000 per financial year, reimbursable against gym memberships, fitness classes, sports equipment, ergonomic accessories, or preventive health services. Claims are submitted on NexSpend under the "Wellness" category.
- **Creche support.** Reimbursement of up to INR 8,000 per month per child for children up to six years of age, in accordance with Section 11A of the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, for a maximum of twenty-four (24) months per child.

7.4 Meal Card

All permanent employees receive a NexoCard meal card loaded with INR 2,200 per month. The credit is part of Fixed Pay and is subject to the tax treatment applicable to meal vouchers. Balances do not expire during employment but are forfeited thirty (30) days after the last working day.

7.5 Salary Advance and Loans

Confirmed employees who have completed twelve (12) months of service may apply for a salary advance of up to one (1) month's net salary, recoverable in six (6) equal monthly instalments, once in any rolling twelve-month period. Applications are made on PeopleHub and approved by the function head and the Head of Payroll.

An interest-free emergency medical advance of up to INR 2,00,000 is available for hospitalisation of the employee or a dependant where the claim is not fully covered by insurance. Approval rests with the CHRO and the CFO jointly. Recovery is over twelve (12) months or from the full and final settlement, whichever is earlier.

7.6 Relocation Assistance

Where an employee relocates at the Company's request or as a condition of a new appointment, the following one-time lump-sum assistance applies:

Band	Relocation assistance	Temporary accommodation
B1–B3	INR 75,000	Up to 10 nights
B4–B5	INR 1,25,000	Up to 15 nights
B6 and above	INR 2,00,000	Up to 21 nights

Relocation assistance is recoverable in full if the employee resigns within twelve (12) months of the relocation, and at 50% if the employee resigns between twelve and twenty-four months.

7.7 Employee Referral Programme

Band of referred hire	Referral award
B1–B3	INR 25,000
B4–B5	INR 50,000
B6 and above	INR 1,00,000

Awards are paid 50% in the payroll following the referred candidate's date of joining and 50% after the referred candidate completes one hundred and eighty (180) days of service. The referrer must be on the Nexora payroll on both payment dates. Members of the Talent Acquisition team, the hiring manager for the

position, and employees at Band B7 and above are not eligible for referral awards.

7.8 Long Service Recognition

Completed service	Recognition
5 years	INR 25,000 gift voucher and a Nexora Craft pin
10 years	INR 75,000 gift voucher and three additional days of Earned Leave credited once
15 years	INR 1,50,000 gift voucher and a sabbatical eligibility waiver

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8. Performance Management

8.1 The Annual Cycle

The Nexora performance year runs from 1 April to 31 March. The cycle has four stages:

Stage	Window	Owner
Goal setting	1–30 April	Employee, approved by manager
Mid-year check-in	1–31 October	Manager
Self-assessment	1–15 April (following year)	Employee
Manager assessment and normalisation	16 April – 20 May	Manager, then the Normalisation Council

Goals are recorded on PeopleHub → Performance and must be specific, measurable and time-bound. Every employee carries a minimum of four and a maximum of seven goals, of which at least one must be a learning goal aligned to the Individual Development Plan and one must be a values goal.

8.2 Rating Scale

Rating	Label	Indicative distribution
5	Outstanding	5–8%
4	Exceeds Expectations	20–25%
3	Meets Expectations	55–60%
2	Partially Meets Expectations	8–12%
1	Below Expectations	2–4%

The indicative distribution is a guide for the Normalisation Council, not a quota to be enforced within an individual team. A manager may propose a distribution outside the guide with a written justification.

8.3 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

An employee rated 1 (Below Expectations), or whose performance materially declines during the year, is placed on a Performance Improvement Plan of sixty (60) days, extendable once by thirty (30) days. The PIP document must specify measurable outcomes, the support to be provided, and the review dates. Fortnightly reviews are mandatory and are recorded on PeopleHub. The HRBP attends the opening and closing reviews.

A successfully completed PIP is closed with a written confirmation. An unsuccessful PIP leads to either redeployment or separation under Clause 15.4.

8.4 Promotions

Promotions are effective 1 July and are decided in the same cycle as the annual compensation review. Eligibility requires:

- (a) a minimum of eighteen (18) months in the current band;
- (b) a rating of 4 or 5 in the most recent cycle, or two consecutive ratings of 3 with a documented readiness assessment;
- (c) an open position at the target band in the approved manpower plan; and

(d) for Band B4 and above, clearance of a Promotion Panel comprising the function head, a Band B6-or-above leader from another function, and the HRBP.

Promotion to Band B5 and above additionally requires completion of the Nexora Leadership Foundations programme (course code NEX-LDR-101).

9. Learning and Development

Nexora commits a minimum of **forty (40) hours of learning per employee per financial year**, of which at least sixteen (16) hours must be on the employee's primary technical or functional track. Learning hours are recorded automatically on NexoraLearn and appear in the performance record.

9.1 Mandatory Compliance Training

The following courses are mandatory for all employees, must be completed within thirty (30) days of joining, and must be renewed on the stated cycle. Non-completion is escalated to the function head at 45 days and is a factor in the annual rating.

Course code	Course	Duration	Renewal
NEX-SEC-101	Information Security Awareness	2.0 hours	Annual
NEX-HR-102	Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)	2.0 hours	Annual
NEX-HR-103	Code of Conduct and Business Ethics	1.5 hours	Annual
NEX-LEG-104	Data Protection and the DPDP Act, 2023	1.5 hours	Annual
NEX-LEG-105	Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption	1.0 hour	Every 2 years
NEX-QMS-106	ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management System	1.0 hour	Every 2 years
NEX-SEC-107	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 ISMS Awareness	1.5 hours	Annual

9.2 Certification Reimbursement

Nexora reimburses examination fees for approved certifications up to **INR 40,000 per employee per financial year**. Reimbursement is 100% where the employee clears the examination at the first attempt, and 50% at the second attempt. Third and subsequent attempts are not reimbursed. The certification must appear on the approved list maintained by the Learning and Development team, or be approved in advance by the practice head.

Certifications reimbursed at a value above INR 1,00,000 in aggregate carry a service commitment of twelve (12) months from the date of certification.

9.3 Higher Education Assistance

Employees with three (3) or more years of continuous service may apply for assistance of up to **INR 1,50,000** towards a part-time postgraduate or executive programme relevant to their role. Assistance carries a service bond of twenty-four (24) months from the date of completion of the programme, and is recoverable on a pro-rata basis if the employee separates within the bond period.

10. Conduct, Ethics and Respectful Workplace — Summary

The Code of Conduct and POSH Policy (HR-POL-002) governs this subject in full. This clause summarises the obligations that apply to every employee without exception.

1. **Integrity.** Do not offer, solicit or accept a bribe, kickback or facilitation payment.

Gifts and hospitality above INR 5,000 in value must be declared on the PeopleHub Gift Register within seven days.

2. **Conflict of interest.** Declare any financial interest, directorship, family

relationship or outside engagement that could reasonably be seen to conflict with your duties, on joining and annually thereafter.

3. **Moonlighting.** Employees must not take up concurrent employment, contract work or a

directorship without the prior written approval of the CHRO. Passive investment, unpaid teaching, and open-source contribution outside client scope are permitted subject to Clause 11.

4. **Confidentiality.** Client data, Company data and colleague personal data must be used

only for the purpose for which access was granted, and never removed from Company-managed systems.

5. **Respect.** Harassment, discrimination, bullying and retaliation are prohibited. Sexual

harassment is dealt with under the statutory procedure set out in HR-POL-002, Part B.

6. **Substances.** Reporting for work under the influence of alcohol or a controlled

substance is a serious misconduct. Nexora offices are alcohol-free except at events expressly authorised in writing by the site head.

10.1 Speaking Up

Any employee may raise a concern about suspected misconduct, fraud, a breach of law or a breach of this Handbook through any of these channels, without fear of retaliation:

- the reporting manager or the skip-level manager;
- the HR Business Partner for the function;
- ethics@nexoratech.in, monitored by the General Counsel;
- the IntegriLine independent hotline on 1800-419-6272, available 24 hours in English, Hindi, Kannada, Marathi, Tamil and Telugu, with the option to remain anonymous.

Retaliation against a person who raises a concern in good faith, or who participates in an inquiry, is itself a serious misconduct and is dealt with under Clause 15.

11. Information Security and Company Assets

11.1 Asset Issue and Custody

Every employee is issued a standard asset kit at joining. The kit is recorded against the employee's ID in the NexServe asset register and must be returned in working condition on the last working day.

Band / role	Standard laptop	Peripherals	Mobile
B1–B3, engineering	14" business laptop, 16 GB RAM, 512 GB SSD	Docking station, 24" monitor, headset	Not issued
B4–B5, engineering	14" business laptop, 32 GB RAM, 1 TB SSD	Docking station, 27" monitor, headset	Not issued
B6 and above	14" business laptop, 32 GB RAM, 1 TB SSD	Docking station, 27" monitor, headset	Corporate handset and plan
Design and Data Science	16" workstation-class laptop, 32 GB RAM, discrete GPU	Docking station, 27" colour-calibrated monitor	Not issued

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Employees are accountable for the assets issued to them. Loss or theft must be reported to NexServe and to the Information Security team within twenty-four (24) hours, and a police first information report must be filed where the loss occurred outside Company premises. The Company may recover the depreciated value of an asset lost through demonstrable negligence, up to a maximum of INR 40,000, from the employee's salary or full and final settlement.

11.2 Acceptable Use

The following are prohibited on Company systems, networks and devices, and are treated as serious misconduct:

- (a) installing unlicensed software or software not approved on the NexServe software catalogue;
- (b) disabling, tampering with or attempting to evade endpoint protection, disk encryption, the data loss prevention agent or the VPN;
- (c) connecting personal removable storage to a Company device, or connecting a Company device to an untrusted network without the VPN;
- (d) transferring client data, source code or personal data to a personal email account, personal cloud storage, a personal device or any generative AI service that is not on the approved list maintained by the Information Security team;
- (e) sharing credentials, multi-factor authentication tokens or access cards;
- (f) accessing systems, records or data for which a business need does not exist, including the personnel records of colleagues.

Use of generative AI tools is governed by ISMS-POL-009. In summary: only the enterprise instances provisioned by Nexora may be used for work; no client-confidential material, personal data or proprietary source code may be entered into any consumer AI service; and AI-assisted code must be reviewed, tested and licence-scanned before it is committed.

11.3 Clear Desk and Clear Screen

Workstations must be locked when unattended. Printed material classified Confidential or Restricted must not be left at printers, on desks overnight, or in meeting rooms. Confidential waste must go into the secure shredding bins on each floor. Whiteboards in client-facing rooms must be erased at the end of every session.

11.4 Monitoring

Nexora monitors its networks, endpoints, email and collaboration platforms for security and compliance purposes, in accordance with the Personal Data Protection Policy (LEG-POL-005) and applicable law. Employees should have no expectation of privacy in respect of data created, stored or transmitted on Company systems, save as protected by law. Monitoring is proportionate, logged, and accessible only to authorised members of the Information Security and Legal teams.

12. Health, Safety and the Workplace

12.1 General Safety

Nexora is committed to providing a safe workplace. Employees must comply with all safety instructions, use the designated emergency exits during a drill or an actual evacuation, and report any hazard, near miss or injury to the Facilities team immediately.

Fire drills are conducted twice a year at each site. Floor wardens and first-aiders are identified by the yellow lanyard and are listed on the notice board at each lift lobby. Each site maintains at least one Automated External Defibrillator at the Level 3 reception and a minimum of six trained first-aiders per shift.

12.2 Visitors

Visitors must be pre-registered on the NexServe Visitor module by the host at least two hours before arrival, must sign the visitor register, must wear a visitor badge at all times and must be escorted by the host in all areas beyond the reception. Client and candidate visitors may not be taken into client-dedicated delivery zones (ODCs) of other clients.

12.3 Emergency Contacts

Site	Security desk	Facilities on-call	Nearest hospital
Gurugram	+91 124 476 2100	+91 98110 44215	Medanta – The Medicity, Sector 38
Bengaluru	+91 80 4917 3300	+91 99860 71142	Manipal Hospital, Old Airport Road
Pune	+91 20 6721 8800	+91 96570 33028	Jehangir Hospital, Sassoon Road

12.4 Prohibited on Premises

Weapons of any kind, combustible or hazardous materials, personal photography or video recording in delivery zones, unauthorised drones, and the operation of any commercial activity for personal gain are prohibited on Nexora premises.

13. Business Travel and Expenses — Summary

The Travel and Expense Reimbursement Policy (FIN-POL-006) governs this subject in full.

All travel must be pre-approved on NexSpend by the reporting manager and, for international travel, by the function head and the CFO. Bookings must be made through the Company's travel desk operated by Trailhead Corporate Travel; self-booked travel is reimbursed at the lower of the actual amount and the fare the travel desk could have obtained, and only where prior written approval was recorded.

Band	Domestic air	Rail	Hotel per night (metro)	Daily allowance (domestic)
B1–B3	Economy	AC 2-Tier	INR 5,500	INR 1,200
B4–B5	Economy	AC 1-Tier	INR 7,500	INR 1,600
B6–B7	Economy (Business above 6 hours)	AC 1-Tier	INR 10,000	INR 2,200
B8 and ELT	Business	AC 1-Tier	Actuals, reasonable	INR 3,000

Expense claims must be submitted within thirty (30) days of the completion of travel. Claims submitted after sixty (60) days are not reimbursed except with CFO approval. Original tax invoices are required for every claim above INR 500. Travel advances must be settled within fifteen (15) days of return; unsettled advances are recovered from payroll.

14. Grievance Redressal

Nexora operates a three-stage grievance procedure for workplace grievances other than complaints of sexual harassment, which follow the statutory procedure in HR-POL-002, Part B.

Stage	Forum	Timeline
1	Reporting manager, or skip-level manager where the grievance concerns the reporting manager	Response within 7 working days
2	HR Business Partner for the function	Written outcome within 15 working days
3	Grievance Review Committee (CHRO, function head, one Band B6+ member from another function)	Written outcome within 30 working days; decision is final

A grievance may be raised at Stage 2 directly where the employee has a reasonable apprehension that raising it at Stage 1 would be futile or would expose them to retaliation. All grievances are logged on PeopleHub with a unique reference and are reported in aggregate to the ELT each quarter.

15. Discipline

15.1 Standards

Nexora expects every employee to comply with this Handbook, the Code of Conduct, applicable law and the reasonable and lawful instructions of their manager. Disciplinary action follows a documented process and is proportionate to the conduct in question.

15.2 Progressive Action

Level	Action	Typical trigger	Record retained
1	Verbal counselling	First instance of a minor lapse	Manager's note, not on personnel file
2	Written warning	Repeated minor lapse, or a first moderate lapse	Personnel file, 12 months
3	Final written warning	Repetition after a written warning	Personnel file, 24 months
4	Suspension pending inquiry	Alleged serious misconduct	Personnel file, permanent
5	Termination for cause	Established serious misconduct	Personnel file, permanent

An employee at Level 3 or above is ineligible for promotion, variable pay above target, and internal mobility for the duration of the record retention period.

15.3 Serious Misconduct

The following are, without limitation, serious misconduct and may lead to termination without notice or notice pay:

- (a) theft, fraud, forgery, falsification of records including timesheets and expense claims;
- (b) wilful damage to Company or client property;
- (c) unauthorised disclosure, removal or destruction of Company or client data;
- (d) sexual harassment, physical violence, threats or intimidation;
- (e) accepting or offering a bribe or kickback;
- (f) reporting for work under the influence of alcohol or a controlled substance;
- (g) conviction for an offence involving moral turpitude;
- (h) concurrent employment in breach of Clause 10.3;
- (i) deliberate misrepresentation in the employment application or during background verification;
- (j) repeated wilful insubordination or refusal to carry out lawful instructions.

15.4 Inquiry Process

Where serious misconduct is alleged, the Company issues a written charge sheet setting out the allegations and the evidence relied upon, and gives the employee not less than seven (7) days to respond in writing. An Inquiry Officer, who has had no prior involvement in the matter, conducts an inquiry at which the employee may be accompanied by a colleague of their choice, may see the evidence, and may cross-examine witnesses.

The Inquiry Officer submits findings to the Disciplinary Authority (the function head for Band B1–B4; the CHRO for Band B5 and above) within twenty-one (21) days of the conclusion of the inquiry. The employee is informed of the decision in writing and may appeal to the Appellate Authority (the COO) within fifteen (15) days.

An employee may be suspended pending inquiry on subsistence allowance of 50% of Basic Salary for the first ninety (90) days and 75% thereafter.

16. Separation

16.1 Resignation and Notice

An employee wishing to resign must submit the resignation on PeopleHub → Separation. The notice period for all confirmed employees is **ninety (90) calendar days**. During probation the notice period is thirty (30) calendar days on either side.

The notice period may be waived or shortened only with the written approval of the function head and the CHRO. Where a shortfall is approved, the employee pays notice-shortfall recovery calculated on (Basic + Dearness Allowance) ÷ 30 per day of shortfall. Earned Leave may not be adjusted against the notice period, and leave taken during notice extends the last working day by an equivalent number of days unless expressly waived by the function head.

A resignation may be withdrawn only with the written consent of the function head and the CHRO, and only before the last working day.

16.2 Exit Process

Step	Owner	Timing
Resignation acknowledged; last working day confirmed	HR Operations	Within 3 working days
Knowledge transfer plan agreed and signed	Employee and manager	Within 10 working days
Exit interview	HRBP	In the last 10 working days
Asset return and NexServe clearance	Employee, IT	Last working day
Finance, library, facilities and access-card clearance	Employee	Last working day
Relieving letter and experience letter issued	HR Operations	Within 5 working days of the last working day
Full and final settlement credited	Payroll	Within 45 days of the last working day

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16.3 Full and Final Settlement

The settlement includes salary for days worked, encashment of Earned Leave up to thirty (30) days, the gratuity amount where payable, and any variable pay expressly declared before the resignation date. It is reduced by notice-shortfall recovery, outstanding advances, unreturned assets at depreciated value, recoverable relocation or education assistance, and statutory deductions.

16.4 Termination by the Company

The Company may terminate employment by giving the same notice as required from the employee, or salary in lieu, other than in cases of termination for cause under Clause 15.3, where no notice is required. Termination on grounds of redundancy is preceded by a redeployment search of not less than thirty (30) days and, where applicable, by compliance with the notice and compensation requirements of the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947.

16.5 Retirement

The age of superannuation is fifty-eight (58) years, calculated to the last day of the month in which the employee attains that age. Re-engagement on a fixed-term consultancy after superannuation is possible with the approval of the CEO.

16.6 Post-Employment Obligations

Confidentiality obligations survive the end of employment indefinitely in respect of client data and trade secrets. The non-solicitation obligation in the appointment letter — not to solicit Nexora employees or clients — survives for twelve (12) months. Employees must not represent themselves as associated with Nexora after the last working day and must update public professional profiles within fifteen (15) days.

16.7 Alumni

Nexora maintains an alumni network for employees who leave in good standing. Alumni receive the quarterly newsletter, invitations to the annual technology conference, and priority consideration for re-hire under Clause 3.6.

17. Definitions

Anchor day — the one working day each week on which a team is expected to be co-located in the office, published by the team's manager.

Band — the career level assigned to a role, from B1 to B8, as set out in Clause 2.4.

Basic Salary — the component of Fixed Pay from which Provident Fund, gratuity, leave encashment and notice recovery are computed.

Confirmed employee — a permanent employee who has successfully completed probation and holds a confirmation letter, or who is deemed confirmed under Clause 3.4.

Continuous service — uninterrupted service with the Company, treating approved leave, statutory maternity leave and Company-directed deputation as service.

Cost to Company (CTC) — the aggregate annual cost of employment, comprising Fixed Pay, Variable Pay and Retirals.

Date of joining (DOJ) — the date on which the employee first reported for duty, as recorded on PeopleHub. Leave accrual, gratuity and long-service recognition run from this date.

Delivery Operating Model (DOM) — the engagement-level document that records working hours, shift pattern, on-site requirements and escalation contacts for a client engagement.

Fixed Pay — the guaranteed annual cash component of CTC, excluding Variable Pay and Retirals.

Full and final settlement (F&F) — the closing account between the Company and a separating employee, as described in Clause 16.3.

Loss of Pay (LOP) — a day of absence for which no leave balance is available and for which salary is not paid.

Net working hours — recorded in-office or logged-in duration excluding the meal break.

PeopleHub — the Nexora human resources management system of record.

NexServe — the Nexora IT service management and asset management platform.

NexSpend — the Nexora travel, expense and reimbursement platform.

NexoraLearn — the Nexora learning management system.

Weekly off — Saturday and Sunday, unless a different pattern is recorded in the engagement's Delivery Operating Model.

18. Annexure A — Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	1 April 2015	R. Sethuraman	First issue
2.0	1 July 2018	K. Deshpande	Restructure; addition of career bands
2.4	1 July 2021	K. Deshpande	COVID-19 remote working provisions; EAP added
3.0	1 October 2023	K. Deshpande	Hybrid model; POSH cross-reference; asset kit table
3.1	1 April 2024	K. Deshpande	Referral award revision; night transport clause; band table refresh

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19. Annexure B — Acknowledgement

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the Nexora Technologies Employee Handbook version 3.1. I understand that it is a summary instrument and that the detailed policies listed in Clause 1.3 govern their respective subjects. I understand that the Company may amend this Handbook at its discretion and that continued employment constitutes acceptance of such amendments. I agree to comply with the Handbook, the Code of Conduct and all applicable Company policies.

Employee name: _____ Employee ID: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Electronic acknowledgement on PeopleHub carries the same effect as a signature under Section 10A of the Information Technology Act, 2000.

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End of Document

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